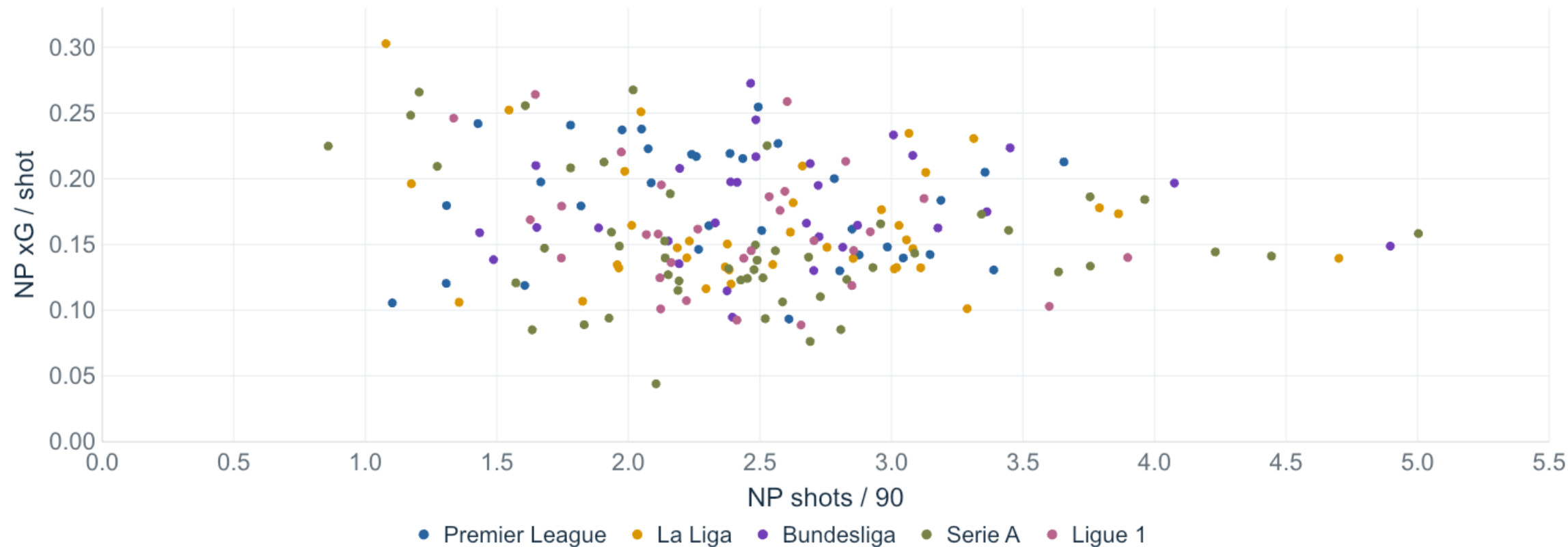


BEYOND GOALS

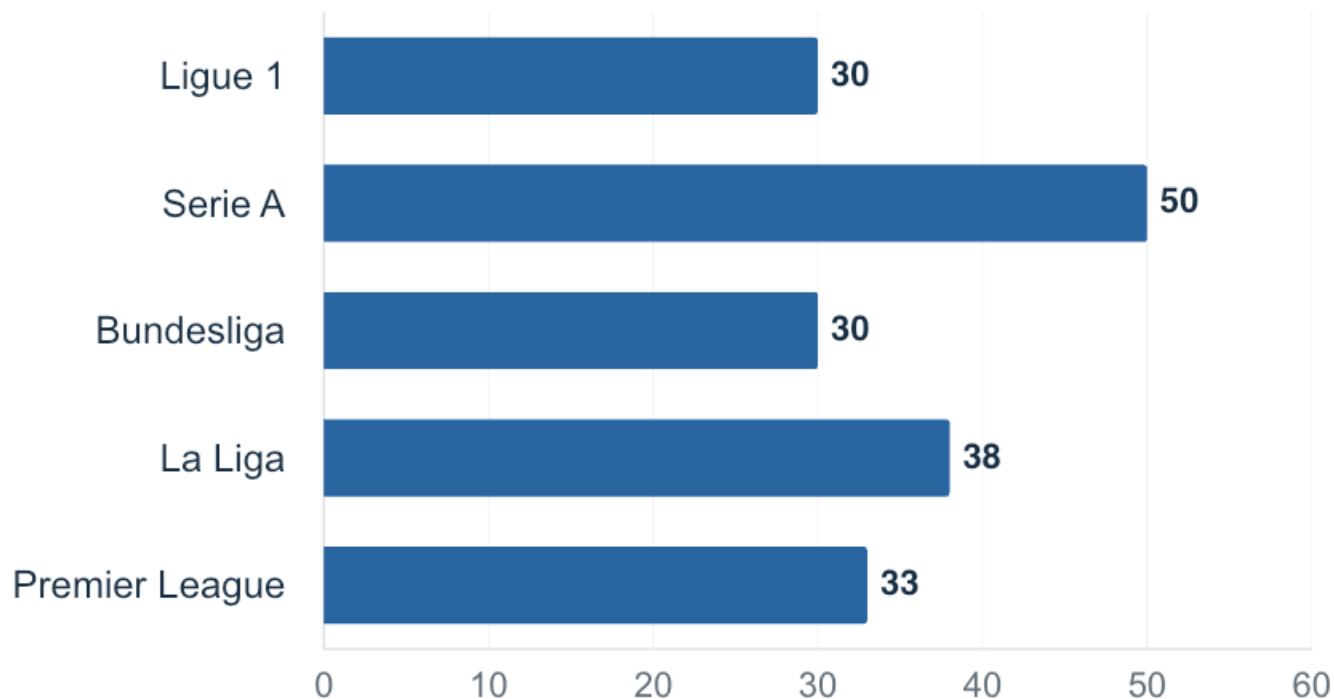
Comparing striker shot profiles across Europe's Big Five leagues



2025/26 — 181 central-forward candidates

The players and the metrics

A saved season snapshot. One row = player × league × season.



181 PLAYERS

900+ MINUTES

VOLUME

Non-penalty shots ÷ minutes × 90

QUALITY

Non-penalty xG ÷ shots

CONVERSION

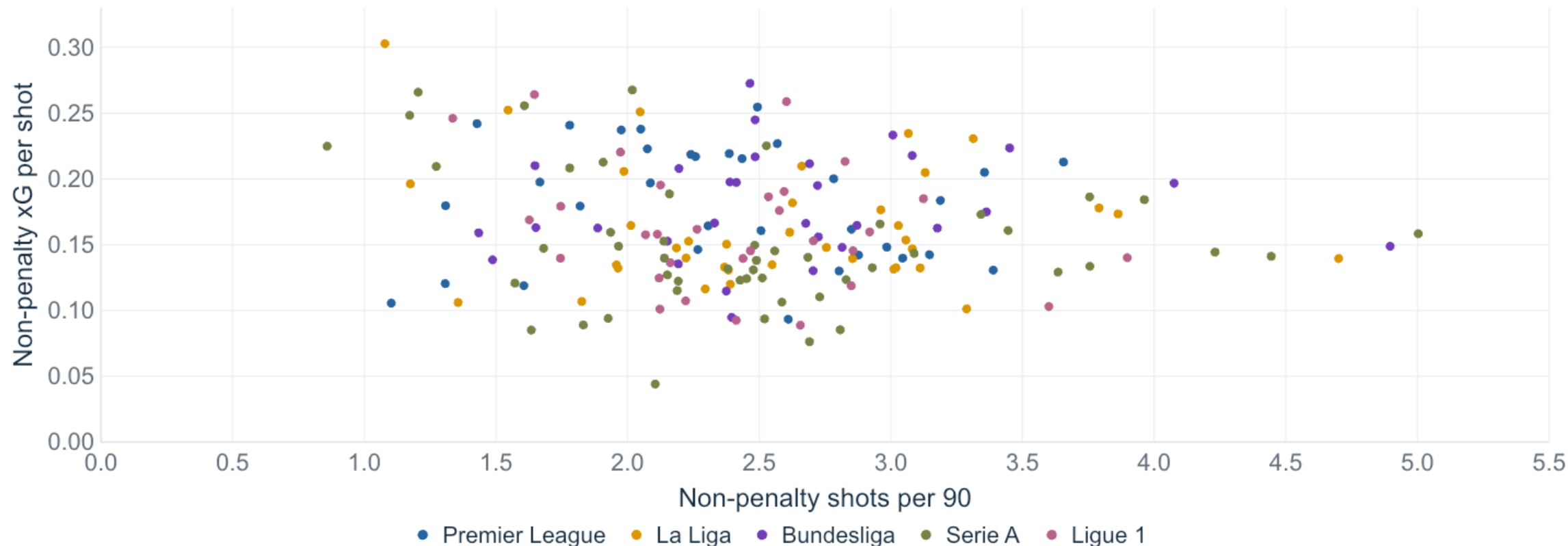
Non-penalty goals ÷ shots

Goals combine opportunity and outcome.

Candidate rules use recorded positions. Team and league context remain unadjusted.

Shot volume vs chance quality

Each point represents one player's league-season profile.

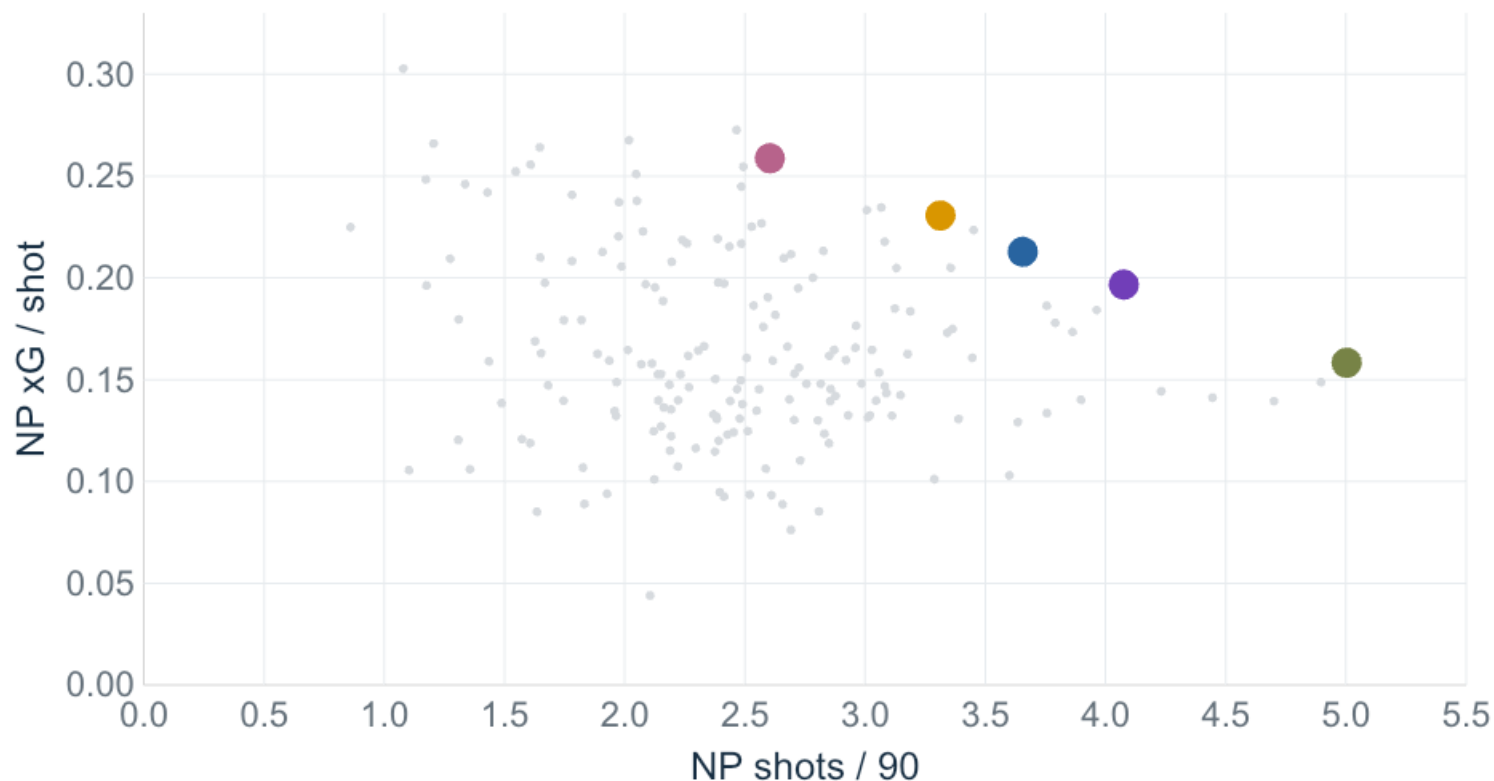


More shots and higher xG per shot describe different dimensions.

Cohort medians: 2.46 NP shots/90 and 0.158 NP xG/shot.

One shot-production standout from each league

Highest non-penalty xG per 90 within each league. 900+ minutes and 50+ NP shots.



Premier League

Erling Haaland

3.66 shots/90 0.213 xG/shot 0.778 xG/90

La Liga

Robert Lewandowski

3.31 shots/90 0.231 xG/shot 0.764 xG/90

Bundesliga

Harry Kane

4.08 shots/90 0.197 xG/shot 0.802 xG/90

Serie A

Nikola Krstovic

5.00 shots/90 0.158 xG/shot 0.792 xG/90

Ligue 1

Pierre-Emerick Aubameyang

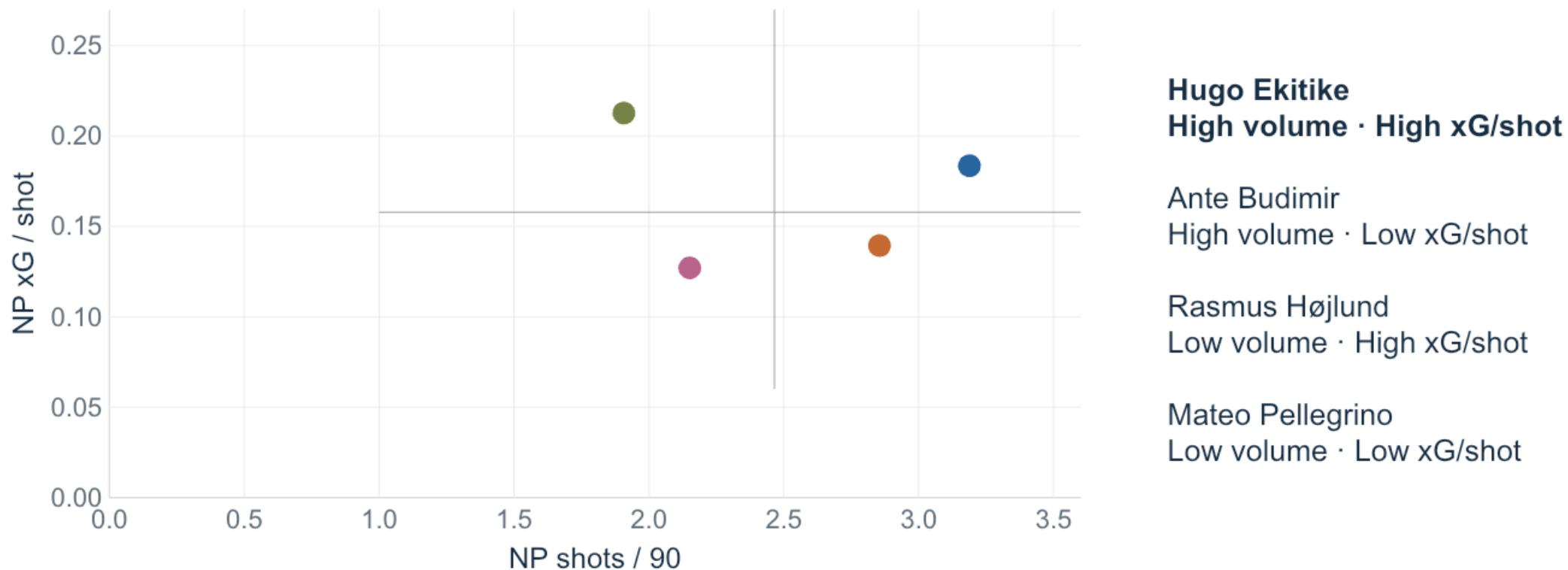
2.60 shots/90 0.259 xG/shot 0.674 xG/90

NP xG/90 combines shot frequency and average chance quality.

League representatives use within-league maxima. They do not all pass the pooled upper-quartile rule.

Why these four case studies?

One central example from each shot-profile quadrant, with at least 50 non-penalty shots.



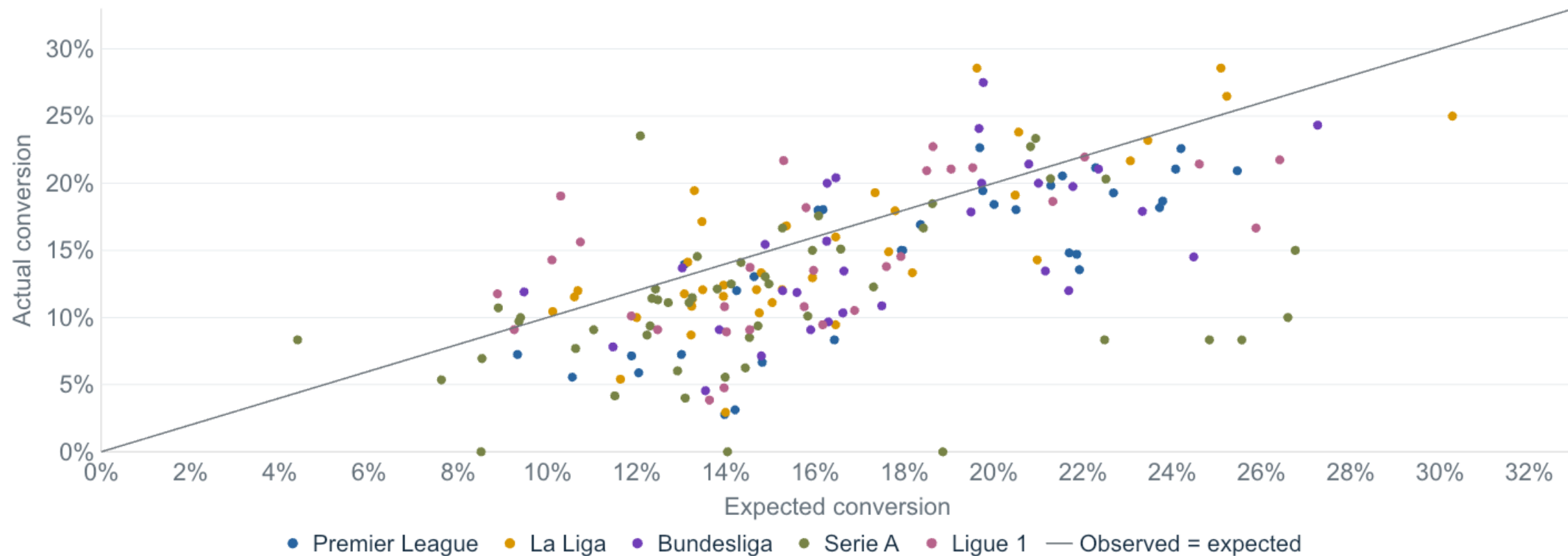
Why these four? To compare shot locations, body-part mix and match variation across contrasting profiles.

Split the cohort at both medians, then choose the player nearest each quadrant's median after scaling the metrics.

These are illustrative cases. High and low are relative to the cohort, not overall ability grades.

Expected vs actual conversion

Penalties excluded. Both axes use goals per shot on the same scale.



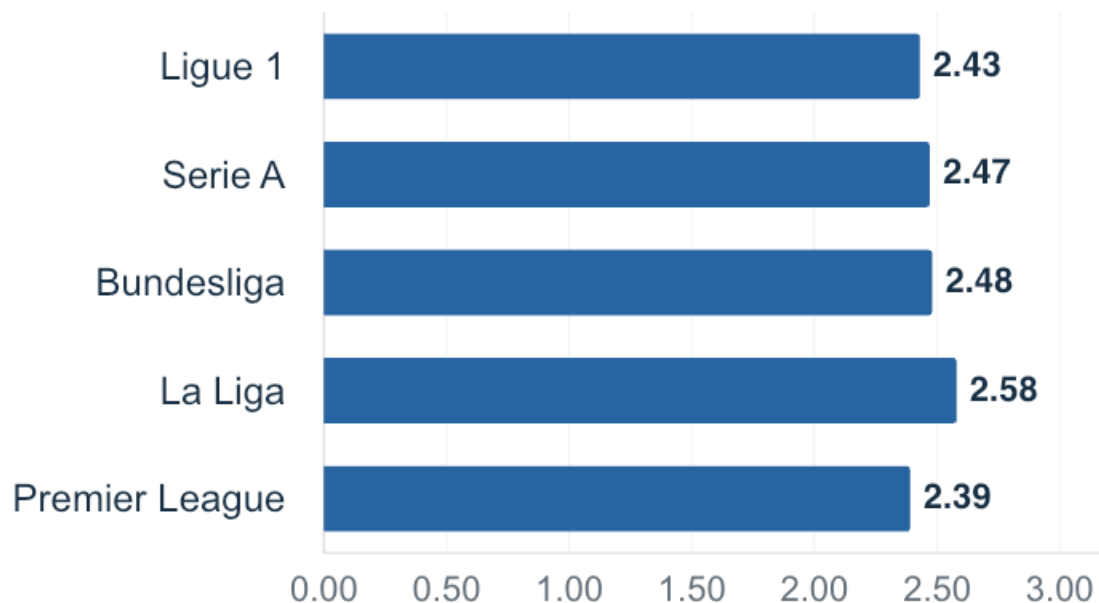
Above the line: more goals than shot xG predicted.

One season and small shot samples cannot establish persistent finishing skill.

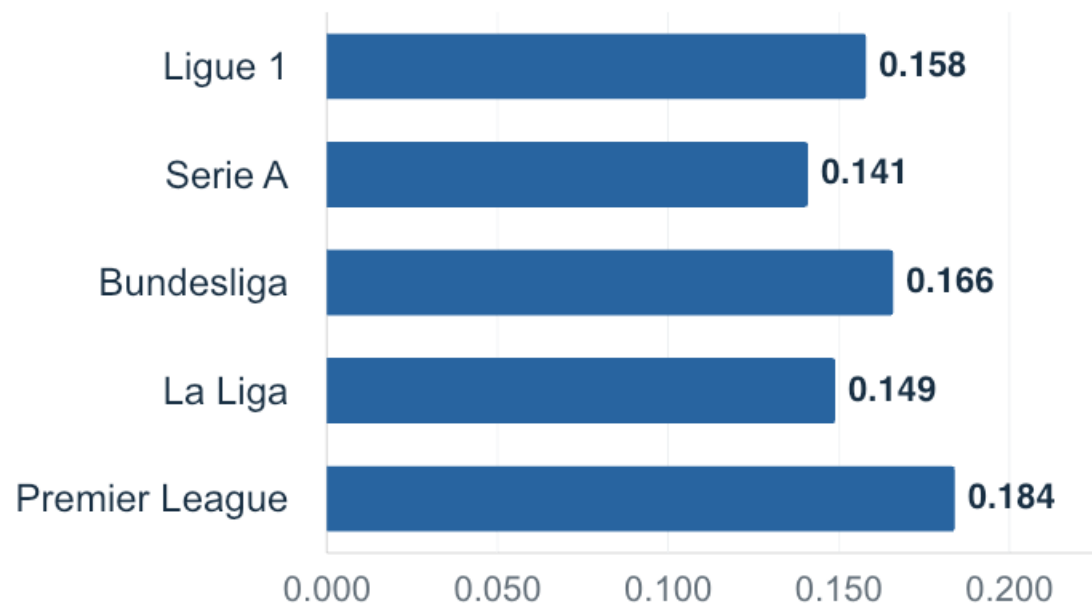
Striker profiles across leagues

Player medians within the selected 900+ minute cohort.

Shot volume: median non-penalty shots / 90



Chance quality: median non-penalty xG / shot

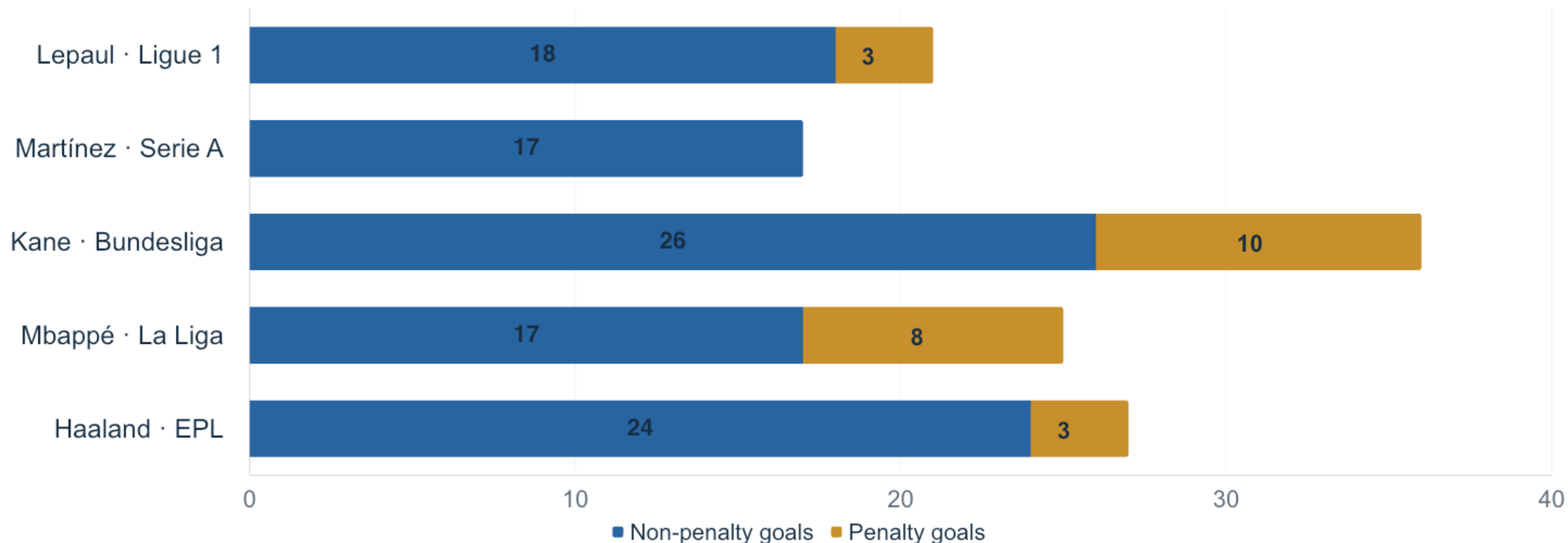


The Premier League cohort has the highest median xG per shot.

Selected-candidate distributions do not measure league strength.

Each league's leading scorer

Maximum total goals in the complete saved Understat player table.

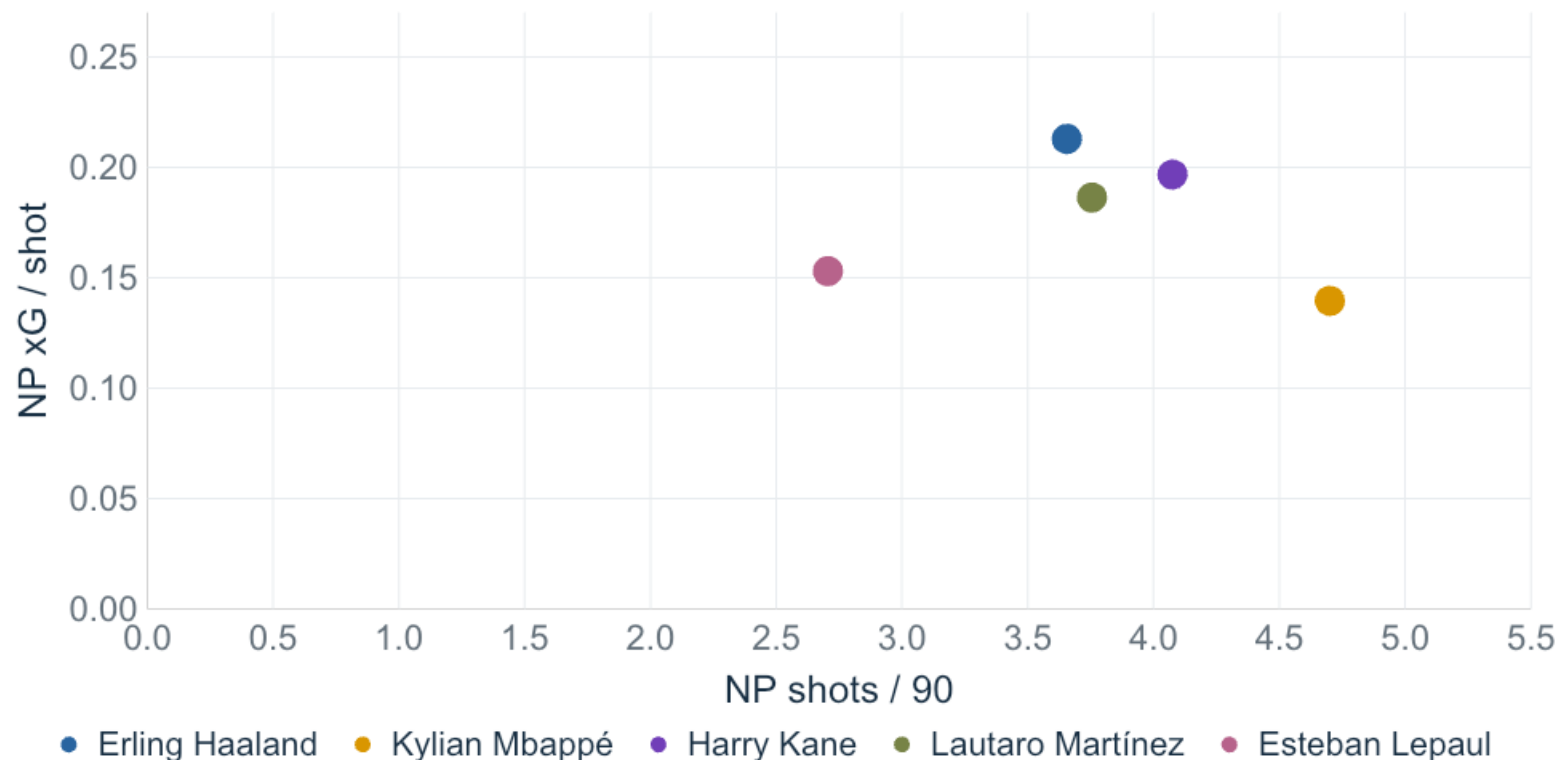


Kane leads with 36 goals, including 10 penalties.

Understat snapshot totals. The bars separate non-penalty and penalty goals.

Different routes to the scoring title

The five leading scorers occupy different shot-volume and chance-quality positions.



Among these five:

Mbappé
Highest shot volume
4.70 NP shots/90

Haaland
Highest chance quality
0.213 NP xG/shot

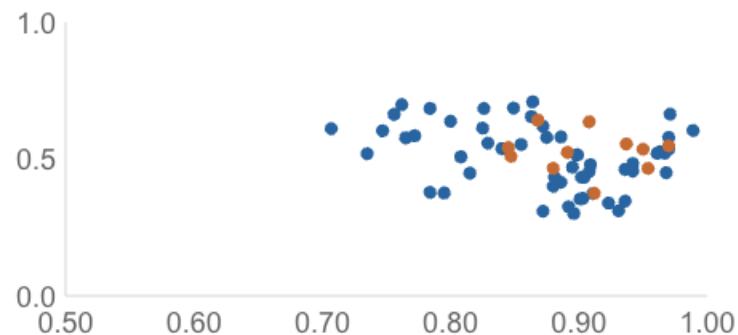
The scoring title can accompany different shot profiles.

Rates describe this season. League and team environments are unadjusted.

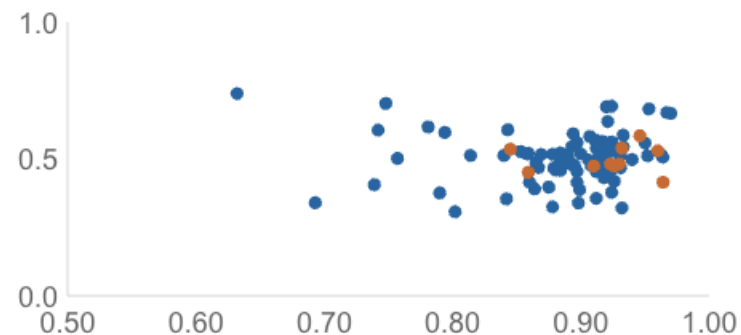
Where the representative strikers shoot

The four quadrant cases: non-penalty attempts in the attacking half. Source coordinates, not metres.

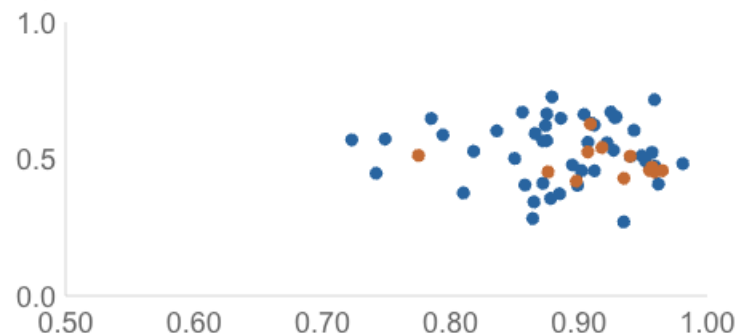
Hugo Ekitike — 65 NP shots



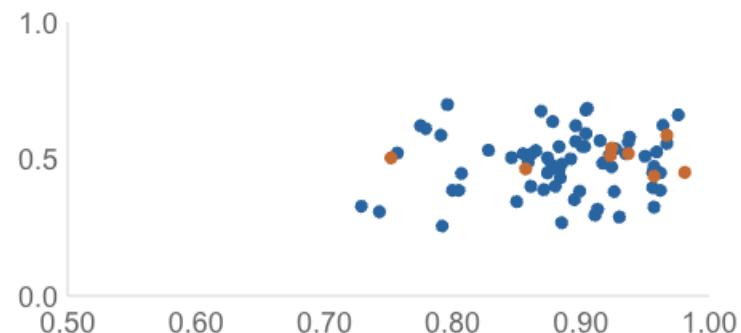
Ante Budimir — 95 NP shots



Rasmus Højlund — 59 NP shots



Mateo Pellegrino — 72 NP shots

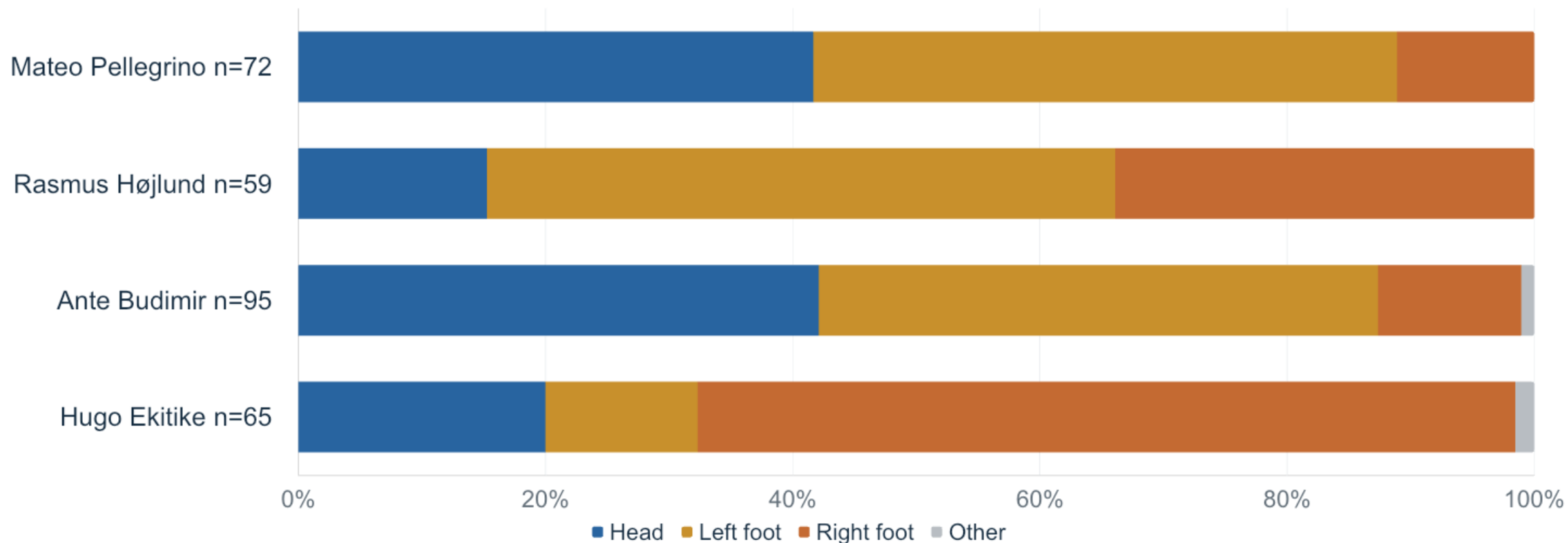


Blue points: other attempts. Orange points: goals.

The source locations show where shots occurred, not how players moved beforehand.

How they shoot

Share of non-penalty attempts by body part, for the four representative cases.

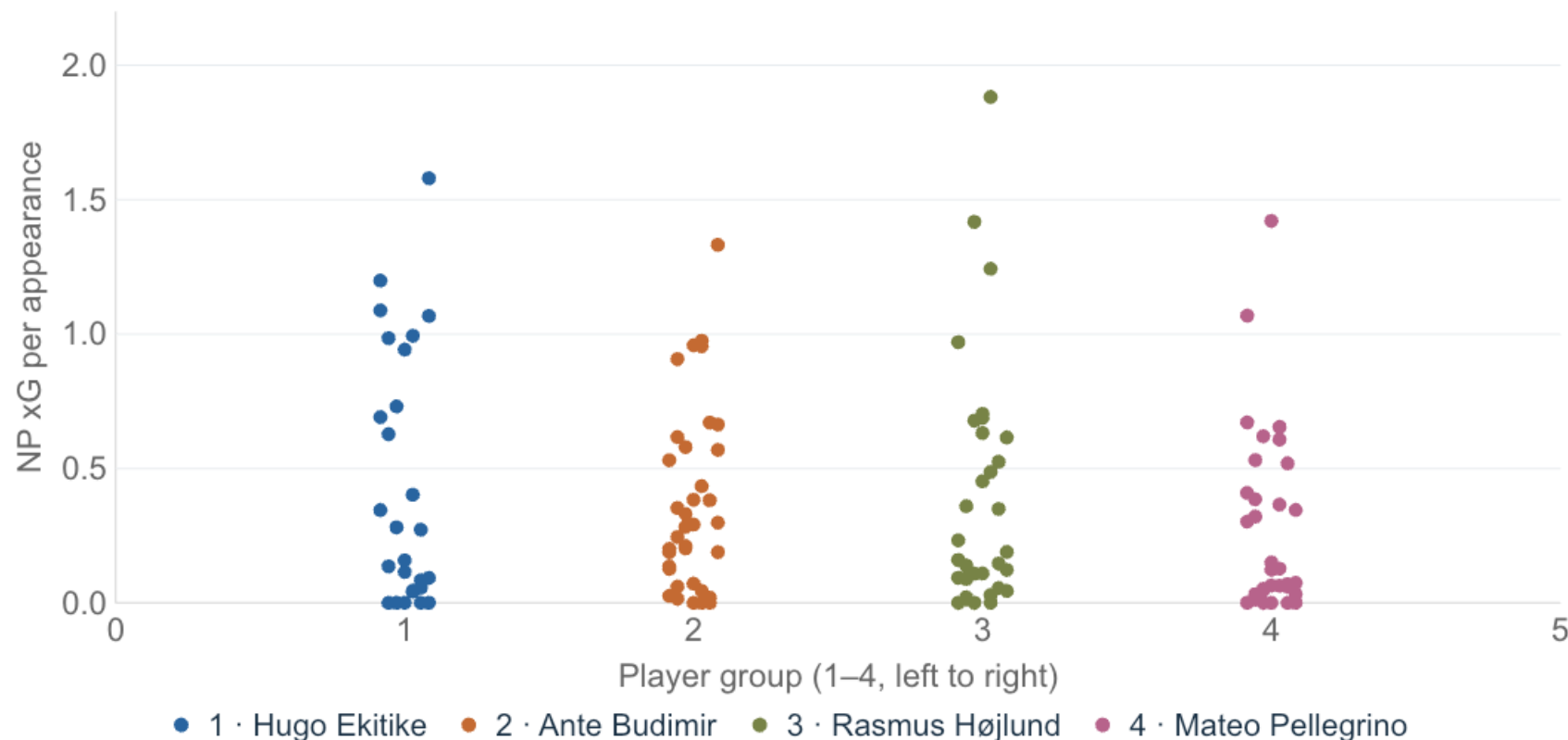


Pellegrino's headers account for 41.7% of his NP shots.

Shot composition describes recorded attempts. It does not establish tactical instructions.

Match-to-match variation

The four quadrant cases: non-penalty xG per appearance, including zero-shot games.



Zero-shot rate in appearances of 60+ minutes:

Hugo Ekitike: 15.0%

Ante Budimir: 5.7%

Rasmus Højlund: 9.4%

Mateo Pellegrino: 24.2%

A season average can hide large differences between matches.

Minutes, opposition and game state vary. These distributions do not isolate player skill.

Findings and further questions

Different profiles can lead to high scoring totals.

4.70

NP shots / 90

Mbappé, highest among the five leading scorers

0.213

NP xG / shot

Haaland, highest among the five leading scorers

+5.31

Goals above non-penalty xG

Lepaul, observed in this saved season

Next: review movement, team context and repeated-season evidence.

Descriptive comparison. No defensive evaluation or overall recruitment ranking.